

Open Source

Digital Media Arts

Artists from the Institute for Electronic Arts (iea)

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开源

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序文

陈小文

19世纪起，西方中产阶级住宅里发生的最大变化是报纸、书刊、地图开始覆盖着人的生存空间，家中设有书房对一个中上阶层家庭来说已成为极其普遍的事情。苔罗思·莱利（Terence Riley）在他的“无私密空间的住宅”中指出：无论美国和欧洲中产阶级如何奋力限制社会对个人空间的侵犯，他们对由媒体所传送的室外现实保持永久的兴趣。报纸和书刊将人们为自己建筑的与外界隔离的空间变成与外界沟通的场所。

德国哲学家马丁·海德格尔（Martin Heidegger）在论述电讯文字和影像传播对人们和事件之间的距离的改变时提出这样一个问题：“在这种同一的格式中每一件事都变得离人不远不近，它是什么？是无距离？万物被揉进无距离的同一格式中。”海德格尔说的“无距离”精彩地概述了19世纪末、20世纪初媒体给人与社会之间的关系带来的特性。直到今天，“无距离”仍旧十分准确地描绘我们与周围世界的间隙，海德格尔无法想像到的是，在数字化时代，人的生存和媒体之间的联系变得更加自然，随着电子媒体的普及，“私宅”变成可渗透的建筑，每时每刻接受和传导影像、声响、文稿和数据。19世纪的传统媒体（报纸和书刊）仅仅缩短了“内”与“外”的距离，而今天的电子媒体和数码多媒体不仅使我们与外界离得更近，而且取消了我们和户外事件在时间上的间隔。

“开源（Open Source）”是一个关于媒体文化的数码多媒体艺术展。入选该展览的艺术家从各自相异的角度，直接或者间接地表现了他们对电脑控制时代（cybernetic times）人和媒体（文化）之间的关系的理解。

在策划和组织“开源”展览的过程中，我明确地感到她不是传统意义上的画展，首先，所有的作品都大大削弱了手工的痕迹（如果不是彻底取消的话）。这不仅仅是因为艺术家在创作的全过程或者某个阶段借助了电脑，更主要的原因是这些艺术家在探索媒体艺术语言时毫不回避海德格尔所说的“同一的格式”，以及“同一的格式”对手工痕迹的取缔。“开源”展出的多数作品还含有另一种倾向：艺术家在有创造性地重新组合现存的视觉语言和媒体文化的过程中寻求艺术个性。虽然，当代艺术作品中摆脱“手工感”和个人风格的现象很大程度上归根于丰富多样的现代化影像制作技术，我们却不能忽略这种现象反映了艺术家对当今社会上物质、信息和影像过剩的反响。

希望能够通过这个展览使我们能更密切地关注伴随数字化时代而来的艺术家和他们的创作。

2001年9月18日

Revolution by Digits

Gerar Edizel

Rochester, August 2001

Art, in the particular modern sense of the term that has gained currency in the West since the eighteenth century, refers to a mutually supporting and generative dyad of concept and practice. This dyad has been promoted and sustained by a complex of institutions and disciplines that were also established in the eighteenth century. They range from the art press to criticism, from galleries to museums, and from aesthetics to art history. Since then, art, as a modern form of meaningful engagement with the world, has permitted the production of significant statements ranging from conformist to dogmatic, from probing to counter-cultural, and from dissident to hedonistic. During its relatively short historical journey, art has undergone frequent transformations that have prompted a reconsideration of provisional definitions. In this context, the work of Marcel Duchamp, especially his ready-mades that consisted of exhibiting mass-produced objects, marked a radical reorientation of the concept. They definitively unmoored art from its previously unquestioned narrow association with an established hierarchy of specific mediums and modes of production. Duchamp's ready-mades, that heralded the post-medium condition of modern art, are nearly a century old. Twentieth-century Western art can be seen as an extended attempt at assimilating or subverting the consequences of Duchamp's intervention. Nevertheless, the apprehension of art through notions determined by medium- and mode-specific approaches continue to survive. They are often evidenced in the contradictory reflexes displayed by many art professionals confronting new artforms.

A conspicuous trend in artistic discourse on digital artmaking reveals a persistent concern for comparing the results of a wide variety of digital processes to those of traditional mediums such as drawing, painting and photography. The related efforts, especially evident in curatorial statements, appear clearly aimed at delimiting the boundaries of new practices by exploring the similarities that link them to traditional medium-centered practices and the differences that distinguish them, as well. Presumably, the need to extend artistic discourse by developing vocabularies and narratives appropriate for new approaches and techniques necessitates such operations. However, the concerns behind these recurrent comparisons seem to contradict some fundamental notions of the frequently heralded "digital revolution" that, in apparent harmony with postmodernist denunciation of hierarchies, has reconfirmed the post-medium condition of the sensuous arts. The question is begged: to what extent have practitioners in the arts shed their hierarchizing reflexes when they continue to worry about the status of an image produced on an ink-jet printer vis-a-vis photographic prints or oil paintings? I suspect the proposed shake-ups of art categories familiarly advanced by traditional art institutions, such as museums, art schools and disciplines such as art history, tend to inadvertently present "revolution" as a threat to their investments in the established order of things. Consequently, the term "revolution" becomes limited to invoking effective taxonomical rearrangements that might allow a deserving junior "medium" to join at the table of its confirmed seniors. Thus, hierarchies based on arcane notions and solidified through institutionalized thought and behavior have confusingly survived into the advanced phase of the post-medium era.

The language of radical change cheerfully adopted by art theorists should arouse some cautionary doubts in us. Does the "digital revolution" deserve consideration as a multi-dimensional and radically transformative social phenomenon worthy of its name or does it hyperbolically refer to significant shifts and reorientations in production-driven economies? If it indeed presages the former, as I believe it does, then, it seems crucial to me that those who have a stake in this "revolution" try to influence its course through conversant and intentional participation. For, although revolutions may result from the catalytic coincidence of an inexorable complex of forces, the direction of their unfolding depends, to a large extent, on the conscious practice rooted in the needs and desires of their proponents. This, of course, is easier said than done.

Before I go any further, I would like to preempt a possible misinterpretation that my criticism of medium-centeredness in art might provoke. I wish to make clear that I am not questioning the validity of investments in medium-specific artistic research and exploration, nor am I doubting the enduring legitimacy of traditional art practices. However, I am interested in advancing an exploded notion of art based on material engagement with all possible modes of expression for the purpose of expanding awareness. In other words, I argue for an inclusive notion where art refers to diversity and hybridity in an unfolding process rather than a specialized production.

New technologies have and continue to undermine vertically ordered and hierarchizing conceptions of art based on idealistically organized interpretations of the world. The idealistic notion of art necessarily begets a vertical axis connecting to the false appearances of the mundane (the supposed worst) to the essential of the ideal (the supposed best). The impurity of former is to be avoided and overcome in an effort to "ascend" to the purity of the latter. This dualistic view of the world--that has afflicted Western thought for millennia--accounts for culturally pervasive obsessions based on the desire for an ultimate and otherworldly Reality (ranging from religious to consumerist promises of bliss), even though it remains by definition unknowable and unreachable. Such a set-up denigrates the horizontal experience of earthly reality and relations in favor of a vertical and unknowable "celestial" Reality. Its vertically hierarchizing structures become alienating, albeit unavoidable and, eventually, invisibly "natural." Consequently, the modern concept of art and its attendant institutions have been constructed according to the pervasive principles of verticality.

The disconnect between reality and alienated human consciousness generate an unbridgeable chasm (presumably overcome in death, trances, and ecstatic visions) between the two ends of the vertical axis where myths proliferate. We attempt at coping with the untenable condition of the fissure in our existence by obscuring it with mystifications. Few human undertakings have been subjected to as much mystification as art has been. Although it would certainly be interesting to speculate on the reasons behind these circumstances, space does not permit to do so in this essay. However, it would now suffice to list the familiar myths of modern art: autonomy, originality, purity, hierarchy, mastery, and genius. New technologies have helped artists effectively discredit these myths by supporting horizontalizing contributions to the unfolding of art.

Autonomy: The myth of autonomy stipulates that art is "created" (not produced or constructed) and "appreciated" (not engaged in or interpreted) according to its own set of principles independent from the constraints of social and cultural connections. Art, then, is a super-social phenomenon occurring in its own sphere to which the aspirants must ascend at the cost of severing their ties from mundane existence.

Originality: Accordingly, the uniqueness of "creations" secure their originality by denying the possibility of a grounding in socio-cultural actuality. Thus, every original artwork gives birth to itself and engenders the onset of a new history of progeny marked by derivation, unless they also manage, in turn, to rise to distinction by achieving originality, themselves.

Purity: It follows that art must be protected in its unsullied state from contamination by mundane actuality--the nitty-gritty tensions, concerns and struggles of life. For, autonomy and originality would be ruined if caught in the impure web of relations of daily existence. The attainment of art, then, involves a soaring out of the morass of materiality in a search for purity by means unavoidably and paradoxically material. Hence, an intense search ensues for essence in painting, truth in the substance of sculpture, sincerity in photography, honesty in clay, fidelity in printmaking, and integrity in technique in general. The celebration of these particular mediums as being inviolate falsely presumes an ahistorical status for them. Moreover, the search for purity in the medium as an end in itself repudiates, by definition, the very nature of medium: a vehicle enabling communication.

Hierarchy: Every idealizing system, by virtue of compelling ascent toward a desirable end, generates hierarchical structures of gradation. Since, in such systems, value obtains from the presumed existence of essential qualities, evaluation disregards the consideration of historical determination and cultural relativity. The much disputed and resented crowning of painting, above sculpture and the rest, as the paragon of the visual arts derives directly from the compulsion to assign rank and order to the status of mediums and modes of production. Effectively, then, the validity and status of new artforms would depend on their legitimation before mediums and modes already established and ranked within the hierarchy. For instance, installation must be justified against sculpture and digital printing, against photography, and so on.

Mastery: Defining art as a pursuit of purity or search for essence transforms the artist into an expert in a narrow field where refining technical virtuosity gains primary importance. Matter becomes a resistant force to be subdued by the willful application of skilled handling by its master. Material mastery through technique mirrors the process of ascent through purification.

Genius: There is a darker side to the establishment of hierarchies and rules of mastery. Systematization and codification of procedures breed uniformity and stymie renewal by discouraging investigative initiatives. The possibility of renewal is entrusted to the unique individual believed to be endowed with extraordinary gifts and whose talents seem predestined for the task: the genius. The myth of genius has been used to explain the works of many artists in ahistorical, asocial and super cultural terms. The myths of artistic autonomy and originality dictate the invention of the genius as their corollary.

The myths of art mentioned above have endured despite their having been exposed, analyzed, and denounced on practical, philosophical, and historical grounds. Artists' use of new technologies based on electronic tools and the computer have finally rendered vertical definitions of art untenable in material terms. As a result, art now refers to a dynamic process by which its practitioners grapple with relevant issues in their worlds through the concrete production of socially and culturally determined meaning. The language of the new tools, of the internet, and interactive multimedia in general, is a shared language that evolves through participation. Innovations and contributions are so interdependent and incremental as to owe credit for their sustenance to communal involvement. The codes that allow the metamorphosis of information from one form to a variety of others and back are in a public domain of interchange. Consequently, in such a communal terrain where collaboration is constant if anonymous, originality becomes an irrelevant concept. The origin of the artwork, if there remains one, no longer resides in the producer or the product but in the interpretive engagement and the performance of the receiver. The vast potential for fluid transformations, combinations, and layering of simultaneous, adjacent or seemingly disparate information into hybrid constructs, renders the concern for purity pointless. The construction of hierarchies requires rigid structures that allow for vertical organizations. The fluidity inherent to the possibilities afforded by digital media has a levelling effect where hierarchical orders cannot be sustained. One cannot speak of structures and levels but, in accordance with Gilles Deleuze's apt metaphor, of horizontally expanding rhizomatic networks. In such a metamorphic terrain where participation almost instantly equates to energizing the potential for change, the desire of achieving mastery over matter/medium becomes an impeding handicap. Finally, the myth of the originaire genius who creates the new out of an endowment of special resources is replaced by the inventive performer who dares to work between established codes and explores, in the Director Peter Sellars' brilliant phrase, "the space where machines have a private nightmare."

The artists participating in this exhibition engage new media technologies not as ends in themselves but, without exception, as a set of tools allowing an expanded range for articulating their concerns. Artists such as Steina and Woody Vasulka, Peer Bode, Pauline Oliveros, and Andrew Deutsch who manipulate real-time processing in video and sound, explore the structure of their unfolding consciousness by focusing on the relation of their sensuous/cognitive bodily apparatus to its environment. Their artistic practice often involves the construction of new tools or the modification of existing ones for unconventional applications. Their works often mirror or simulate generative patterns of thought and recollection in such a way as to suggest that the receiver's observational performance is simultaneously documented. This form of art stresses the significance of embodiment in relation to the making and experiencing of art.

Similarly, the sensorially provocative prints by Ann Hamilton probe the material embodiment of language and its relation to experience. Our bodily relation to and imaginative projection into our environment concern the sonic ambiances produced by Stephen Vitiello and Tetsu Inoue, and the evocative and layered reconstructions of landscapes by John Wood and Phillip George. Pam Hawkins' video installations about the misuse of water and Brandon Ballengee's prints of deformed amphibian specimens question the problematic aspects of our intricate but neglectful relation to

the environment where our life finds sustenance. Kiki Smith's career as an artist has been dedicated to the questioning of our usurpation of power and assumption of dominance as humans over nature evidenced by the imposition of arbitrary taxonomies that obscure a wealth of potential relations with the world.

The possibilities inherent to multi-dimensional layering of information and its analysis afford artists such as Mary Lum, Kathryn Vajda, Robert Brinker, and William Contino with the possibility of investigating the construction of their memory through architectural, spatial, and textural analog. Latent meanings embedded in the construction of memory and its recall in the form of historical narratives engage Xiaowen Chen and Darrin Martin's examination of the manipulation of sense in the gap between fragments of a story. Peculiar applications of a similar strategy of dislocation or incongruous juxtaposition respectively inspired by surrealist collage and internet-browser interface allow Pamela Joseph and Judy Sylwester to venture into the absurd underbelly of signification.

The role of cultural conditioning in the construction of self involves the video-based compositions of still or moving narrative sequences by Kim Beck and Lara Odell, respectively. Their inquiries search for the particular sources of desires and longings revealed in their individual experiences. Self-conception through the contrivance of an internalized fictional relation to an Other engages the stark juxtapositions in Marlise Mumenthaler's prints.

New technologies extend and intensify vision in ways that allow some artists to direct their focus on presenting aspects of the world that remain overlooked by or inaccessible to our perceptual apparatus. Joseph Scheer's high-resolution prints and Lynne Roberts-Goodwyn's photographic installations feature portraits of moths and birds that astound with beauty in their diversity of form, color, and design. Their works prove that the mis-application of the term "ordinary" to life-forms derives from a human deficit in observational acuity. Finally, Jessie Shefrin uses digital video for a radical slowing of our rhythms of perceptual intake in order to widen our awareness. Her work reveals a network of unsuspected synergy sustaining a collective unconscious. Her decelerations manage to demonstrate the paradox of the centrality of what falls to the periphery of our perception.

The artists featured in this exhibiton contribute with their works to the unfolding revolution in our conception and practice of art. In this essay, I have attempted to show in what ways our evolving notion of art might be reclaiming a role of social and cultural integration and relevance for artistic research. I will not presume to know where the revolution prompted by the digital intersection of languages and processes might be headed. Such claims would be predicated on the false certainties promised by vertical thinking and based on a linear understanding of historical development. The rhizomatic model of dynamic networks recasts specialization in the context of a myriad of horizontal possibilities and rescues artistic discourse, including the interpretation of historical art, from the grip of institutionalized segregation. We are not uninvolved observers in the midst of some revolutionary "flow" that we can observe run its course from atop our museums, galleries or art history offices, but active participants in a process that we can directly help define with our various contributions.

Tools of Change and Transformation

Pauline Oliveros

Profound change in music and all the arts - driven predominantly by technology throughout the 20th century - will more than likely increase at an even more rapid pace in the 21st century.

Two inventions in the 20th century enabled the unprecedented change in the creation, performance, and dissemination of music: recording and the personal computer.

One hundred years of recording exposed musicians and the public to all forms of music in a global perspective - a mind expanding development.

For musicians, the ability to record and immediately hear what was performed has enormously enhanced musicianship. Trained musicians can now play almost any form of music very well. This was not true before personal recorders were available.

20th century composers entered a new realm of creativity with electronic music. Experiments in electronic music began early and accelerated with the availability of magnetic tape recording. Organizing sounds by editing and splicing tape was a new form for composers. The second important invention was the personal computer, a new means of controlling and organizing sounds, enabling composers to deal with more complex rhythms, sound mixtures and form.

The marriage of computing and recording has given composers and performers amazing flexibility in their compositions and performances.

Creators and performers of music are now on the brink of new challenges that will come from biotechnology in this century. By 2010 computers will have similar computing power as the human brain according to scientist Ray Kurzweil. It will be necessary to understand how to deal with ever more rapid change and complexity in music and the hybridization of computers and humans.

Following is an excerpt from my article *Quantum Improvisation: The Cybernetic Presence* concerning a design for a "musician chip":

On my musician chip I would like:

The ability to recognize and identify instantaneously any frequency or combination of frequencies in any tuning, timbre in any tempo or rhythm, in any style of music or sound in any space.

The ability to produce any frequency or sound in any tuning, timing, timbre, dynamic and articulation within the limits of the selected instruments or voices used. Maybe I would also like to morph from any instrument to any other instrument or voice at will.

The ability to recognize, identify and remember any music - its parts as well as the whole - no matter the complexity.

The ability to perceive and comprehend interdimensional spatiality.

The ability to understand the relational wisdom that comprehends the nature of musical energy - its form, parts and underlying spirituality - as the music develops in performance.

The ability to perceive and comprehend the spiritual connection and interdependence of all beings and all creation as the basis and privilege of music making.

The ability to create community and healing through music making.

The ability to sound and perceive the far reaches of the universe much as whales sound and perceive the vastness of the oceans. This could set the stage for interdimensional galactic improvisations with yet unknown beings.

I suppose it would be great to be able to print it all out as well in 3D color.

What is absolutely essential for being a composer or performer or indeed a person in the next decade or two is a serious ability to adjust to a continuous rate of technological change unprecedented in the history of our species.

通过数字,革命

居拉·艾迪扎 文
沈京功 译

艺术,特别是在从18世纪以来西方通用的现代术语中,涉及一个相互支撑、相互生发的观念和实践的二元论。这个二元论通过同样也是在18世纪确立的复合型学院和学科制度得到持续和发展,包含了从艺术新闻到评论,从画廊到美术馆,从美学到艺术史的范畴。从那时起,艺术作为一个意味深长的现代形式与世界合谋,成为从清教徒到教理神学者,从监察制度到反文化,从持不同政见者到享乐主义者所认可的重要产品。在其相关的短暂历史时期,艺术忍受了临时定义的频繁转换。在这样的上下文中,杜桑(Marcel Duchamp)的作品,特别是构成其作品的大多数制成物——“现成品”,标志了一次激进观念上的再定位。这决定性地解放了先前不被置疑的、确定了特定媒介和作品样式的艺术形式。杜桑宣告现代艺术的后媒介状况的“现成品”概念已经诞生将近一个世纪了,在20世纪,西方现代艺术可以被看作是对杜桑现象存在的吸收和消解的拓展性尝试。然而,媒介和样式特征决定概念的艺术理解还是幸存了下来。这常常对立地表现在一些职业艺术家与新艺术形式的对抗。

在数字艺术创作的艺术评论中,一个显著的倾向显示其意图在于把各种数字手段与传统媒介(素描、油画和摄影)进行比较。其效果明显地指向通过探讨与传统媒体手段的异同对新实践进行界定。推测起来,需要为新方法和技术的成为必须而发展词汇和叙述方式来扩展艺术评论的操作性。然而,隐藏在这些周期性的对照后面的意图是似乎与表面上与后现代解构权威的“数字革命”融洽的一些基本概念相矛盾,这些概念重新确立感官艺术的后媒体状况。需要解决的问题是:当艺术工作者老是在担心相对摄影和绘画的喷墨打印图像的性质时,他们在何种程度上能摆脱等级观念的影响?我怀疑,由传统艺术机构(美术馆、艺术学院)和艺术学科(艺术史)所倡议的艺术门类更新,其目的趋于忽视当前的“革命”,这一革命已成为他们所建立的秩序的威胁。因此,在他们看来,“革命”这一术语仅限于允许新“媒体”论资排辈地进入以约定俗成为序列的分类法。这样,基于深奥的概念和顽固的制度化思想及行为的阶层得以在后媒体时代高级阶段混淆地生存下来。

被艺术理论兴高采烈地采用的、激进变化的语言应该引起我们审慎的怀疑。“数字革命”真的值得像其名称一样被看作一个多维度、具有激进变革力的社会现象,或其只是夸张地暗示了一次在产品主导经济下意义重大的转换和再定位吗?如果它真的兆示了前者,正如我相信的那样,那么,看来对我来说至关重要的就是那些在这“革命”中通过主动接近与参与而试图影响其进程的人们。为了也许只是一个无情的复杂力量催化的偶然结果的革命,他们拓展的方向——在很大的程度上——依赖于立足在支持者的需求和欲望之上的自觉实践。当然,这说起来容易。

在我走得更远之前,我想要先声明也许使我的“艺术媒体中心论”具有挑衅性的一个可能的曲解。我希望明确我并不置疑某种媒体艺术研究和探索的合法性,也并未怀疑传统艺术实践不朽的正当性。无论如何,我的兴趣在于推进一个以扩展认知为目的,基于材料与一切可能的体验模式相结合的艺术观念。换言之,我赞成一个把涉及艺术展开过程中的多样性和杂交性涵盖的观念,而不是一个特定的结果。

新技术曾经而且一直在颠覆着基于唯心主义的阐述世界的艺术的垂直秩序和等级观念。艺术的唯心观必然导致一根联系两端的纵轴:从虚假的世俗表象(被假定为最劣)到完美的真(被假定为最优),为了“提升”到后者的纯洁,前者的粗陋应被避免和克服。这个折磨了西方思想整个世纪的二元世界观——即使残存在定义不可知和不可触及的企图

上——也说明了基于对终极真理的渴望（从宗教到消费主义的极乐允诺）所带来的文化上的普遍困惑。如此的设定诋毁世俗真实的横向体验而偏爱自上而下和不可知的“神圣的”真实。其垂直性等级结构开始疏离虽不可避免，但最终却不可见的“自然”。从而，依照垂直性普遍深入的原理，艺术的现代概念及其相关机构被建立起来了。

在真实和疏离的人类意识之间产生了介于神话繁衍之处的纵轴两端的鸿沟。我们试图用神秘化来隐晦在我们无能为力的存在上的裂痕，一些人类事业也曾像艺术那样的被神秘化所左右。虽然在此情境下进行投机会很有趣，但在本文中并没有留下这样的空间。无论如何，现在能够列出一些现代艺术中常见的神话：自律、创新、纯粹、等级、技艺熟练以及天才。通过支持拓展艺术的横向贡献，新科技已帮助艺术家们有效地使这些神话失去了霸权。

自律：自律的神话保证艺术是依照独立于社会和文化关系之外自我设置的法则而“创造”（而非生产或构成）和“领悟”（而非从事或阐释）的。那么，艺术就是发生在以切断世俗生活为代价的自我的领域的一个超社会现象。

创新：相应的，“创造”的惟一性通过否定生物社会学现状的基本可能性来保全其独创性。于是，所有创新的作品给予自身生命，并酿成一个被标记了起源的衍生物的新历史的开端，由其自身相互作用达成创新而锻造辉煌。

纯粹：艺术必须要在纷扰的尘世间——在现实的压力、生活的挣扎和欲求中——保有其纯洁性。因为，一旦被污浊的日常生活关系网捕获，自律和创新就必然堕落。然后，艺术的造诣，包括了高高翱翔在物质性沼泽上空的，通过意义无可奈何的相互矛盾的物质来寻求纯粹的努力。从此，开始了对绘画之精髓、雕塑之本真、摄影之真挚、陶瓷之率直、版画之忠实以及技艺之完整的热切追求。这些被纯化的特定媒体的庆典错误地为其假定了一个史无前例的身份。此外，经由定义媒体的根本性质——一个使交流成为可能的媒介，在媒体中对纯粹性的寻求成为其自我批判的终点。

等级：任何理想的体系，经由强制向一个欲求终点攀升的效力，都会造就一个分层的阶级结构。因此，在这样的体系下，价值来自假定的品质精髓的存在，其评价过程漠视历史决定性和文化相对性。最易引起争论和不满的是笼罩在绘画头上的光环，它作为视觉艺术的典范，凌驾于雕塑和其他媒体之上，直接强制性地给媒体的身份和作品的样式划分等级和秩序。于是，新艺术形式身份的合法化就有赖于在等级制度里已经确立的媒介和模式。举例言之，装置必须针对雕塑证明其正当性，数字媒体印刷必须为摄影和版画对自身进行调整，等等。

技艺熟练：艺术一旦被定义为对纯粹的追求或本质的找寻，就把艺术家转换到一个在以技艺精纯为第一要素的狭窄领域里的专家角色。内容和形式都变成了掌握技艺者任意运用技法的借口。通过技法达到的物质性熟练映射了通过纯粹化达成的等级上升过程。

天才：等级制度及技艺熟练尺度之确立有其阴暗的一面。程序的体系化和典籍化因顽固的学术优先权在扶植一致的同时阻碍复兴。复兴的可能性被托付给那相信是被赋予了非凡的天赋并由其才能而注定的独特的个体——天

才。天才的神话常被用作空前的、自我中心的和超文化的术语来解释一些艺术家的作品。艺术自律和创新原则之神话——作为其必然的推论——发明了天才。

上面提到的艺术之神话是持久的，即使它在实践、哲学和历史的意义上被揭露、分析和指责。艺术家基于电子工具和计算机的应用实践，终于诠释了在物质意义上站不住脚的艺术垂直定义。作为一个成果，通过社会和文化决定其意义的具体作品，艺术现在涉及艺术工作者与其世界相关问题争斗的一个动态的过程。新工具的语言——互联网、互动多媒体是一种通过参与而进化的共享语言。改革和奉献是如此的相互依赖、相互推动，使得公众的参与不可避免。编码允许信息的形态从一个形式向其他多种形式变异，并回归到公共交换的领域。从而，在匿名的持续协作的公共图景下，原创成为失效的观念。艺术作品的原初，如果还残存着一个的话，不再栖居在作品或作者中，而是存在于转译的规则和受众的接受过程中。转换流变的极大潜力把表面上类似或迥异的信息构成杂交的结构，从而放弃无意义的纯粹。等级的建构要求允许垂直机构的刚性结构，而数字媒体与生俱来的流变性在等级秩序无法维持之处具有整平的效果，虽不足以对结构和层次发言，但就像 Gilles Deleuze 的贴切的比喻那样，是一个水平展开的根茎状网络组织。在参与几乎立刻等同于解放的变革潜力时，任何在素材/媒体上建立知识优势的欲望都是阻碍的力量。终于，来自独特天赋的创新天才的神话被敢于在既定编码和探索之间——正如导演 Peter Sellars 所说，在机器做噩梦的地方——进行发现的行动者所取代。

本展览中的艺术家并不是以从事于新媒体科技为最终目的，而是——毫无例外的——把新技术作为他们阐明其意向的一系列工具。Steina 和 Woody Vasulka, Peer Bode, Pauline Oliveros, 以及 Andrew Deutsch 这些熟练运用实时处理创作声音和视频的艺术家，通过把集中注意力在其亲身体验器材环境之感觉和认知之间的关系，探索他们展开的知觉结构。他们的艺术工作常常包括制造新设备或为非常规的用途对设备进行改装。他们的作品常以将受众的观看行为假设为同时性文献的方式，反射或模拟记忆或思想生成的模式。该艺术形式强调关于艺术制作和体验的具体性的意义。

类似的，Ann Hamilton 刺激感官的作品探究语言的物质化体现及其与经验的关系。与我们的肉体相关并隐射我们的外界关注的是由 Stephen Vitello 和 Tetsu Inoue 所作的声音氛围作品，以及 John Wood 和 Phillip George 的重新构造的风景。Pam Hawkins 关于水的滥用的录像装置和 Brandon Ballengee 的畸形两栖动物印制作品置疑在我们赖以生存的环境中复杂且被忽略的关系中可疑的概念。Kiki Smith 决定她的艺术家生涯将置疑通过模糊大量与世界潜在关联的、武断的分类法，将人类置于自然之上而篡夺的权力和假想的优势。

多维度层次的信息的内在可能性及其分析，为艺术家 Mary Lum, Kathryn Vajda, Robert Brinker 和 William Contino 提供了通过建筑、空间和肌理模拟研究记忆之结构的可能性。深藏在记忆中的潜在含义及其历史叙事的回想，使陈小文和 Darrin Martin 从事于处理在历史碎片间裂缝的感觉的实验。一个相似的将混乱或不协调并置的策略的特殊运用，分别通过超现实拼贴和互联网浏览界面给 Pamela Joseph 和 Judy Sylwester 带来在荒诞的隐含意义中工作的灵感。

新技术扩充和强化了呈现世界观念的方式的视域,容许一些艺术家把他们的注意力集中在那些难以接近我们知觉器官的世界。Joesph Scheer 高分辨率的印刷媒体和 Lynne Roberts-Goodwyn 的摄影装置以其在形式、色彩和图案上的多样性而带来的惊人美丽的蛾和鸟的肖像为特征。他们的作品证明,在生命形式上错误地使用术语“普通”来自人的观察敏锐性的缺乏。最后, Jessie Shefrin 使用数字视频极端地降低我们的知觉节奏,进而扩展了我们的认知。她的作品揭示了维持一个集体无意识的、未被怀疑的协同作用的网络结构,慢速处理并论证了开始于我们感官外围的中心性的自相矛盾。

展览中艺术家的特征及其作品,在我们的艺术观念和实践中贡献了开拓性的革命。在本文中,我尝试去显示,作为艺术家的探索,在何种方式上我们艺术进化的主张可以回到社会和文化的角色。我并不会假设我知道,在语言和方法的数字十字路口推动的革命会走向何处。如此的宣称会是基于垂直的思考和历史发展的线性理解而做出的想当然的允诺。动态网络化的根茎状结构会在充满无数危险的可能性的上下文中重铸专业性,包括历史意义上艺术的解释,并从体系化隔离的掌握中拯救艺术评论。我们不是在我们能观察的从美术馆、画廊和艺术史机构之上运用其方针的革命之“流变”中的不被包括的观察者,而是在我们的各种贡献能直接帮助定义的过程中积极的参与者。

变换和转化的工具

坡利·奥利弗斯

在音乐和其他所有艺术中意义深远的变革——在20世纪是以科技力量驱动的，在21世纪它会更迅猛地发展。

在20世纪，有两项发明空前地改造了音乐的创作、演奏和传播方式——录音和个人电脑。

一百年的录音为音乐家和公众展现了在全球景观下所有形式的音乐——一个扩展思维的发展。

对音乐家来说，能录制并即时回放其演奏的能力极大地提高了对音乐的感受力。熟练的音乐家可以演奏几乎任何形式的音乐，这在个人录音机出现之前是不可想象的。伴随着电子音乐，20世纪的作曲家进入了一个新的创作领域。电子音乐的实验很早就开始了，并由于磁带录音机技术开始有实用性而得到促进。通过编辑和剪接来组织声音曾是作曲家的新形式。

另一个重要的发明是个人电脑给予控制和组织声音的新意义。电脑使作曲家得以处理更复杂的旋律和声音合成形式。而电脑和录音技术的联姻给作曲家和演奏家的创作和表演提供了令人惊叹的弹性。

音乐的创作和演奏现在正面临即将来临的生物工程学的挑战。按科学家 Ray Kurzweil 的说法，到2010年，计算机可能会拥有相当于人脑的运算能力。这将必须去了解任何需应对且更为迅速的音乐的变化性和复杂性以及人类与计算机的互动。

以下是我的文章《量子的即兴演奏》中的节选：关于设计一个“音乐芯片”的控制论存在。

在我的音乐芯片里我希望：

能即时识别任何的频率或任何调性下的频率成分，任何节奏或旋律中的音色，任何风格的音乐或任何空间中的声音；

能产生在任何音调、速率、音色里的任何频率或声音，任何所选乐器或噪音音域里具有的动态特征和清晰度，也许我还希望能够从任何乐器转变到任何其他我需要的乐器或噪音形态；

能识别和记忆任何形式的音乐——无论多么复杂的部分或整体；

能感知及领会多维的空间性；

能理解领会音乐精神的相关智慧——形式、片段和潜在的灵性——作为在演奏中逐步展开的音乐主题；

能感知及领会精神上的联系，能感知及领会作为音乐创作之基础和基本权利和所有生命与造物之间的相互依赖；

能通过音乐创作而建立统一性和治疗效果；

能探测和感知宇宙的辽远，正如聆听鲸鱼的声音而感知海洋的辽阔，这将为与未知的生命一起进行交互空间的庞大即兴演奏搭造舞台；

我假想能把它们全用3D色彩印刷出来会很不错。

在下一个10年或20年，作为一个作曲家或演奏家或仅仅作为一个人，绝对基本的能力是把我们自己调整到我们的时空史上科技空前变化的持续速率上。

Branden Ballengee

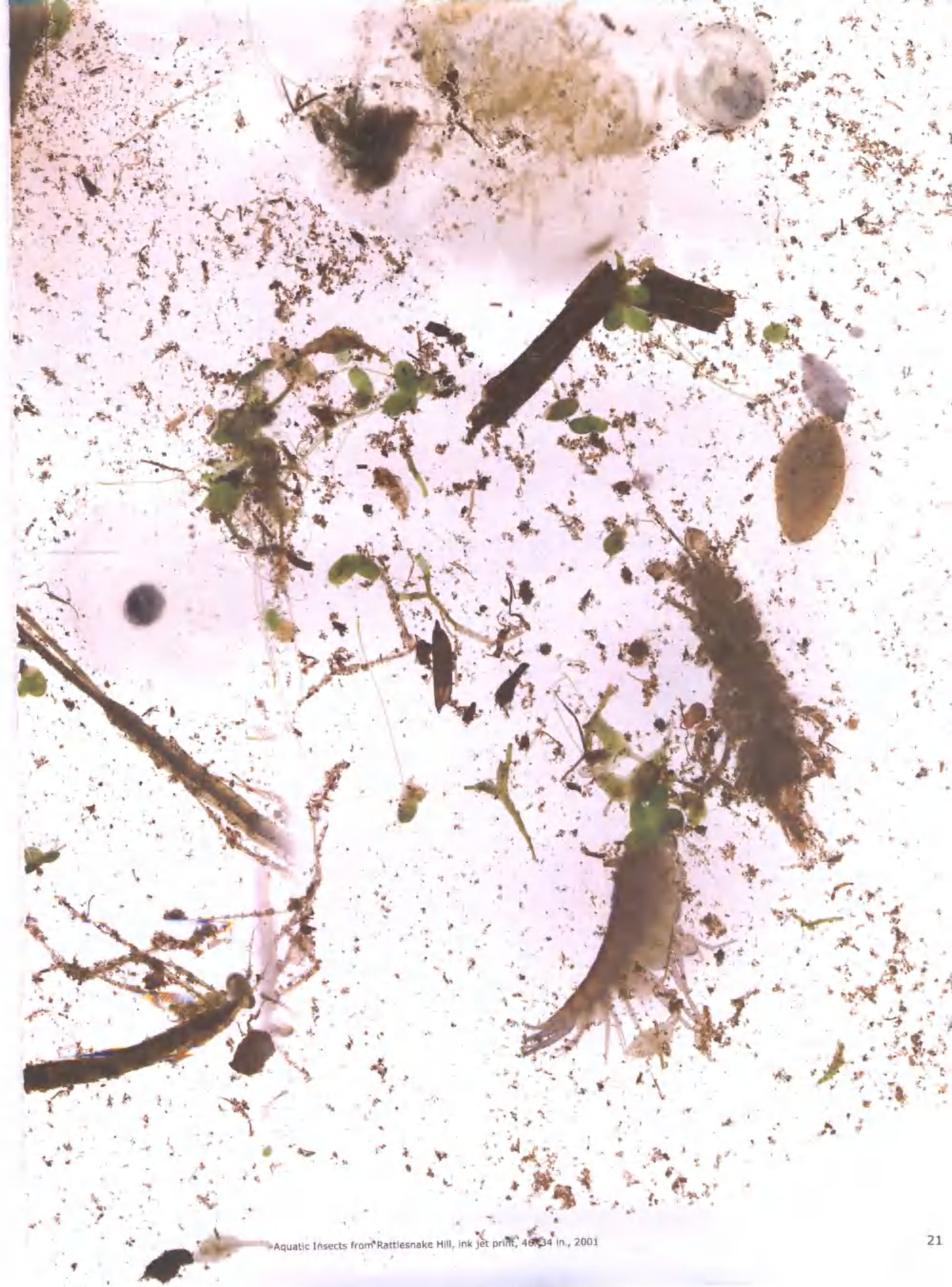
1989年，在国际爬虫类会议上科学家们担忧地发现，他们来自世界各地的同事都注意到两栖动物数量减少、品种灭绝以及肢体畸形。事实上，这发生在全球范围内，即便是在人迹罕至的像巴西被保护的雨林这样一些工业发展不可能成为环境破坏因素的地区。可能的解释包括物种之衰退、原生地之丧失、非本土竞争物种的引入、臭氧层变薄导致的紫外线增加、未知的真菌以及化学污染。依芝加哥动物学公园从事两栖灭绝与变异防治的 George Rabb 所说，当前有超过 200 种两栖类动物已经或濒临灭绝。

Branden Ballengee, B.A. 2001
 The Maryland Institute College of Art, The Art Academy of Cincinnati
 and The New York Studio Program. He currently lives and works in New York City. Over the last six years, he has corresponded and collaborated with scientists from around the world. Ballengee has participated in and initiated numerous amphibian wetlands. He has also worked with field biologists doing amphibian observations in New York State and Tennessee. Ballengee has exhibited his work at Exit Art, NYC; The Brooklyn Museum, Brooklyn, NY; The Queens Museum, Queens, NY; The Islip Art Museum, Oakdale, NY; and has exhibited internationally.



In 1989, scientists meeting at an international herpetology conference made an alarming discovery that their colleagues everywhere were noticing amphibian population declines, species disappearances and physical malformations. Reports came in from virtually all over the globe, even from remote and pristine areas where habitat destruction from industrial expansion could not be a factor, such as Yosemite National Park and protected Brazilian rain forests. Possible explanations include loss of pristine habitat, the introduction of non-native competitive species, increased ultra-violet radiation from ozone thinning, evasive fungi and chemical pollution. According to George Rabb, of the Chicago Zoological Park and the Task Force on Amphibian Declines and Deformities, more than 200 amphibian species are now extinct, critical, or endangered.

Brandon Ballengee attended The Maryland Institute College of Art, The Art Academy of Cincinnati and The New York Studio Program. He currently lives and works in New York City. Over the last six years, he has corresponded and collaborated with scientists from around the world. Ballengee has participated in and initiated numerous amphibian wetlands. He has also worked with field biologists doing amphibian observations in New York State and Tennessee. Ballengee has exhibited his work at Exit Art, NYC; The Brooklyn Museum, Brooklyn, NY; The Queens Museum, Queens, NY; The Islip Art Museum, Oakdale, NY; and has exhibited internationally.





我的作品试图模糊在环境艺术和生态学研究之间已然暧昧的界限。在开始一个项目时，我经常从野生物学或动物学机构寻求技术和理论资料，也在其他的个案中与科学家合作创作作品。并作为艺术家参与和关注野生动物保护以及全球物种多样性的消失。过去的5年里，研究了两栖动物的衰退和畸形，参与和推动了遍及北美的沼泽地调查。当前我是北美两栖类动物畸形报告中心(NARCAM)的观察员并人工饲养了大量的濒危物种。田野研究的数据被转化为概念上形式的环境论外延之视觉对话。

My work attempts to blur the boundaries between environmental art and ecological research. When initiating a project, I often solicit technological or theoretical information from field biologists or zoological organizations. In other cases, I have collaborated with scientists to create a work. As an artist involved in wildlife preservation, global disappearances of biodiversity are both a concern and a focus. Over the past five years I have been studying amphibian declines and deformities. I have initiated and participated in numerous wetlands surveys throughout North America. Currently I am a field observer for the North American Reporting Center for Amphibian malformations (NARCAM) and have begun to breed a number of threatened species. The data obtained from the field work is transformed into a visual dialogue that becomes a conceptual form of environmental outreach.







Kim Beck

I use images which are at once sublime and banal, full of nostalgia and emptiness, that resonate with my experience living in suburbia.

As part of the American Jewish Diaspora, my family moved west from Eastern Europe to New York City and then to Colorado, the Promised Land of big skies and houses. Growing up in the suburbs of Littleton, Colorado, most weekends I was driven by my parents to shopping malls with evocative, poetic, hopeful names like Southwest Plaza, Southglenn Shopping Center and Cinderella City, dropped off and picked up later after hours of wandering. Most years, we flew across the country to New York to visit the family, all still living in the same neighborhood. These images resonate with a longing to belong - my parents' longing to blend into middle class American culture.

These images also echo my desire to try to remember, to reproduce a cultural history, which my parents willingly forgot. In their translation to digital print media, the images become placeless places, suggestions of the suburban landscape as seen through the window of a car. The prints are doubled to reference a stereoscope, suggesting that these places are not unique, but are multiple, repeatable, seen as in double vision. The act of blurring functions as a central metaphor for memory and forgetting, difference and assimilation.



Kim Beck 韩国现代，素描和视觉艺术家，当前在艾尔福特大学任客座助理教授

使用与我所体验的乡间生活有共鸣的图像，充满乡愁与虚无，平凡而庄严。

作为美国犹太移民的一支，我的家族从西欧来到纽约城和科罗拉多州——承诺了广阔的天空和土地的大陆。我在科罗拉多小镇的乡间长大，差不多每个周末父母驾车带我去那些名叫西南广场、中天购物中心、灰姑娘城等拥有充满诗意、启示和希望的名称的商场逛上几个小时。多年来，我们飞越大陆去纽约看望仍和老邻居住在一起的亲人。这些图像与对归属的渴望共鸣、与我的父母对融入美国中产阶级文化的渴望产生共鸣。

这些图像同时也是我试图记起、试图重建我父母欣然忘却的文化历史的欲望的回声。经过数字印刷媒体的转换，图像成为无处之处，暗示从车窗望去的偏僻景色。参照立体摄影，作品以双联版画的形式出现的结果使这些场景在不完全一致的同时具有多重性和可置换性，就像双重视觉。模糊的效果被作为铭记与遗忘、差异与同化的中心隐喻。

